

Organization

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TUM School of Management, Campus Heilbronn



Course agenda

Date	Main theme
13.04.2026	Definitional basics of organization
20.04.2026	Formal organizational design
27.04.2026	Organization and environment
04.05.2026	Strategic organization design
11.05.2026	Technology and organization
18.05.2026	Information technology, AI, and organization
01.06.2026	Informal organization

Date	Main theme
08.06.2026	Informal organization
15.06.2026	Dynamic perspectives on organizing
22.06.2026	Guest lecture, Felix Ehrenfels, mmmake
06.07.2026	Trends in organization design
13.07.2026	Trends in organization design
17.07.2026	Review and wrap-up

Session 09

Dynamic perspectives on organizing:

From snapshots in time to processes over time

What you should be able to do after this session

Learning goals

- Understand that organizations are dynamic phenomena that unfold over time.
- Understand problems in implementing organizational change.
- Understand central change management concepts, their capabilities and limitations.



Image source: ChatGPT

Definition of organizational change

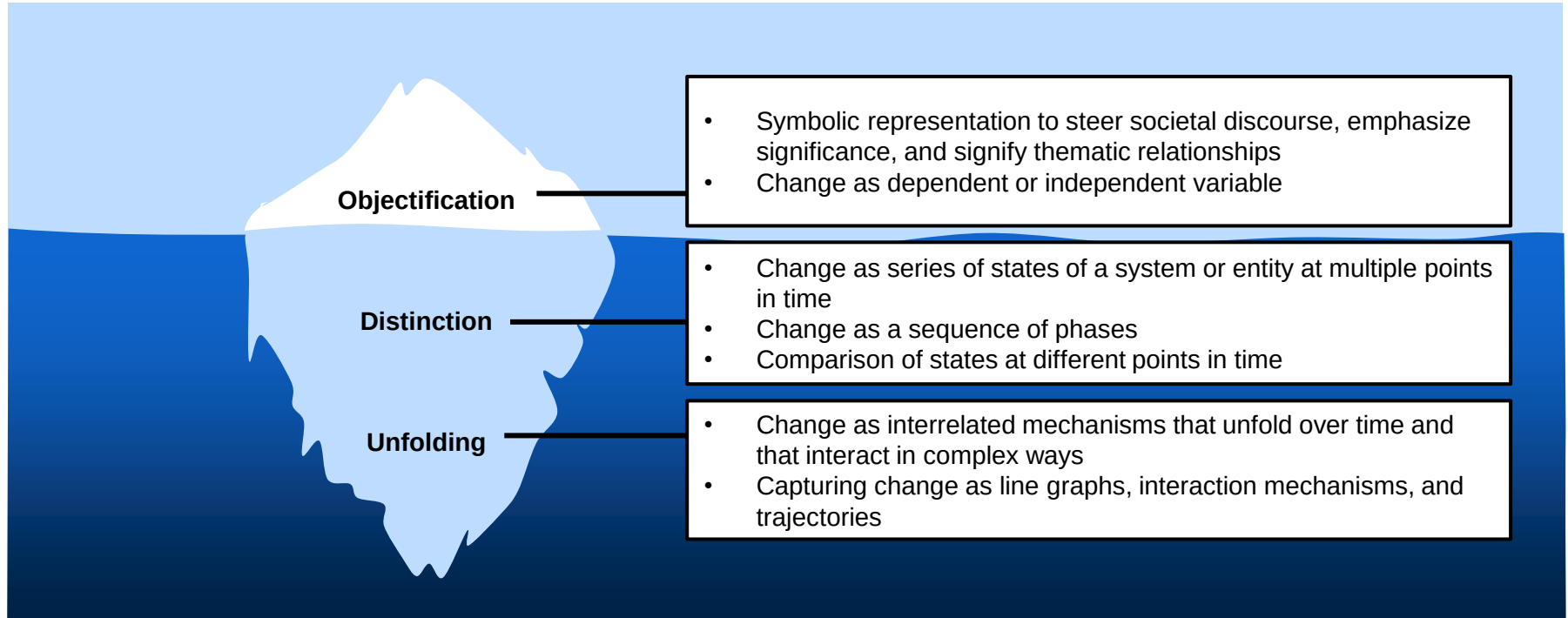
Change refers to differences in the state, form, or properties of an entity across two or more points in time, as well as to the processes or mechanisms through which these differences emerge.



Image source: pexels, Christian Buergi

Different perspectives on organizational change

The Iceberg Model of Change



Mahringer, C. A., Schmiedle, L., Albicker, L., & Mayer, S. (2025). The Iceberg Model of Change: A taxonomy differentiating approaches to change. *Heliyon*, 11(2).

Managing organizational change



In organizations, the problem is how to steer change to intended outcomes

Consulting and survey evidence suggests that many transformation initiatives fall short of their original ambitions. Estimates vary depending on how success is defined, but the consistent pattern is that implementation remains difficult.

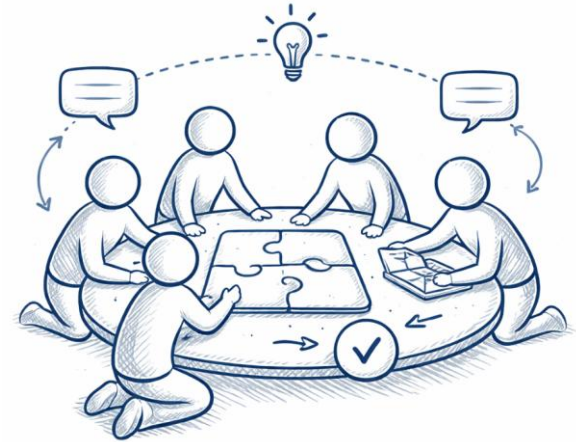
- Bain: 12 percent of business transformations achieve original ambition
- Gartner: 48 percent of digital initiatives meet or exceed targets
- BCG: 30 percent of large-scale tech implementations meet time, budget, scope

<https://www.bain.com/about/media-center/press-releases/2024/88-of-business-transformations-fail-to-achieve-their-original-ambitions-those-that-succeed-avoid-overloading-top-talent/>; <https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2024-11-06-gartner-survey-reveals-only-48-percent-of-digital-initiatives-are-successful>; <https://www.bcgplatinion.com/insights/why-70-of-transformations-miss-the-mark-and-how-to-fix-them>

Gallery Walk “Managing Organizational Change”

Exercise Part 1: Gallery Walk Preparation

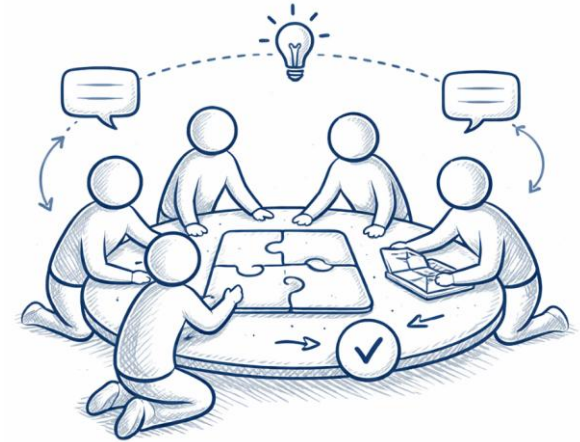
- Form groups.
- Each group selects one of the following change management concepts
 1. Kotter's 8-Step model
 2. Lewin's Change Model, including Force Field Analysis
 3. ADKAR Model
 4. Bridges Transition Model
 5. Appreciative Inquiry
 6. SCARF Model
- Create a flipchart that introduces the concept.
 - Potential points to include: concept illustration, practical examples, some problems, typical use cases.



Gallery Walk “Managing Organizational Change”

Exercise Part 2: Gallery Walk

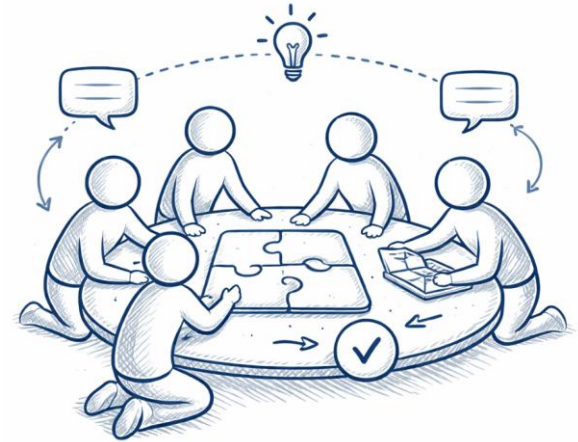
- Visit the other groups and discuss the concepts.
- One group member needs to stay with the flipchart.



Gallery Walk “Managing Organizational Change”

Exercise Part 3: Debrief

- Summarize the discussion that you had in your group.
- Briefly present your insights within the plenum.

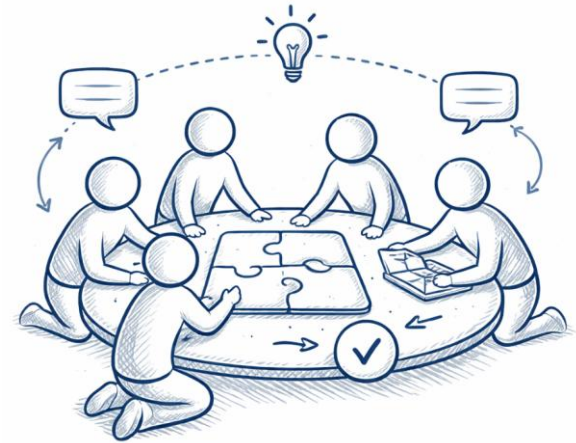


Gallery Walk “Managing Organizational Change”

Exercise Part 4: Case application

A medium-sized technology firm introduces an AI-based project management tool. The tool should improve transparency, automate reporting, and help managers identify delays earlier. Employees are skeptical. Some fear surveillance. Team leads worry that the tool will reduce their autonomy. The IT department argues that the tool is technically ready, but several teams continue using their old spreadsheets. Senior management wants visible progress within three months.

- Apply your change concept to this case.
- What should managers do first?
- What problem does your concept help to diagnose?
- What would your concept probably overlook?



Gallery Walk “Managing Organizational Change”

Exercise Part 5: Impediments to change

- Discuss the key problems in managing change
- Document them on the [whiteboard](#)



Feedback

Please fill out the survey



Guest lecture

Planned session in the course agenda

Topic: Skills as the New Currency of Organizations

Date: 22.06.2026

Lecturer: Felix Ehrenfels, mmmake

Teaser: As organizations become faster, flatter, and more project-based, traditional job architectures are no longer enough. This session explores how companies can shift from role-based thinking to skill-based organizing: identifying critical capabilities, increasing internal mobility, and aligning talent decisions with business strategy. From an organizational psychology perspective, we will also look at the impact on motivation, identity, fairness, and employability.



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Contact information



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